

RADIOLOGY TERMINOLOGY - MEDICAL REFERENCE

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COMMON IMAGING MODALITIES

1. X-RAY (RADIOGRAPHY)

- Uses ionizing radiation to create images
- Best for: Bones, chest, dental imaging
- Common findings: Fractures, pneumonia, tumors

2. CT SCAN (COMPUTED TOMOGRAPHY)

- Cross-sectional imaging using X-rays
- Best for: Detailed organ visualization, trauma
- Terms: Hypodense (darker), Hyperdense (brighter)

3. MRI (MAGNETIC RESONANCE IMAGING)

- Uses magnetic fields and radio waves
- Best for: Soft tissues, brain, spinal cord
- No ionizing radiation

4. ULTRASOUND

- Uses high-frequency sound waves
- Best for: Pregnancy, abdominal organs, blood flow
- Real-time imaging, safe and non-invasive

COMMON RADIOLOGY TERMS

- Opacity: Area that blocks X-rays (appears white)
- Lucency: Area that allows X-rays through (appears dark)
- Consolidation: Filling of airspaces in lungs
- Atelectasis: Collapsed or airless lung
- Effusion: Fluid collection (pleural, pericardial)
- Mass: Abnormal tissue growth
- Nodule: Small rounded lesion
- Calcification: Calcium deposits in tissue

CHEST X-RAY FINDINGS

- Cardiomegaly: Enlarged heart
- Pneumothorax: Air in pleural space
- Infiltrate: Abnormal substance in lung tissue
- Fibrosis: Scarring of lung tissue

Note: Always correlate imaging with clinical findings.